

HEALTH AND SAFETY MANUAL

The Hays Companies Group

Office subset (CORE-OFC)

Version 1.2 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

Issued by Corporate Safety | Approved by the Chief Executive Officer

This manual is issued by and speaks only for The Hays Companies Group.

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The Hays Companies Group

CHAPTER 1. POLICY STATEMENT AND SCOPE

The signature block and entity variables are completed at issuance at assembly.

1.1 Safety Policy

It is the policy of The Hays Companies Group that every person on our work goes home in the same condition they arrived. No schedule, no client demand, and no dollar amount changes that. Safe work is a condition of employment at every level of this company, and it is a condition of leadership: managers and supervisors are accountable for the safety of the people they direct.

The Company commits to the following:

- Provide the equipment, training, planning time, and staffing that safe work requires.
- Identify hazards before work begins and control them before anyone is exposed.
- Comply with every applicable safety and health regulation, and go beyond compliance where our work demands it.
- Investigate every incident and near miss to fix the system, and hold people accountable under one standard, consistently applied.
- Back every employee who stops work over a safety concern. Without exception.

Every employee commits to work by this manual, follow the 7 Rules That Keep You Alive, plan their work, look out for the person next to them, and stop work when something is wrong.

_____

Kirby Hays, Chief Executive Officer Date

1.2 Scope

This manual applies to every employee of The Hays Companies Group, on every jobsite, facility, yard, and vehicle, on every shift. It applies to temporary employees and to any person working under the Company's direction. Subcontractors are governed by their own programs and by Chapter 22 where this entity acts as a controlling contractor.

This manual is issued by and speaks only for The Hays Companies Group. It creates no obligations for, and makes no statements on behalf of, any other company.

1.3 Related Programs and Order of Precedence

This manual works alongside the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline), the Fleet Management Program, the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, the Workplace Violence Prevention Plan, and client site rules and contract safety exhibits. Where requirements differ between any of these documents, or between this manual and a regulation, the stricter requirement governs. Where a client rule is stricter than ours, we follow the client rule on that client's work. Where ours is stricter, ours applies everywhere.

Nothing in this manual creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment.

Version 1.0 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Maintained by Corporate Safety.

CHAPTER 2. SAFETY ORGANIZATION AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Named persons for this entity are listed in Appendix A so personnel changes never require a manual revision.

2.1 How Responsibility Runs

Safety responsibility follows the chain of command. It is never delegated away: assigning a duty to someone does not remove it from the person above them. The named-person table for this entity, including the IIPP Administrator, is in Appendix A. Competent person designations by discipline are kept in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety; anyone who needs to know who is competent person trained for a task contacts Corporate Safety.

2.2 Responsibilities by Role

Chief Executive Officer

- Owns this policy. Signs it, funds it, and holds leadership accountable to it.
- Sits on the review committee for Step 3 and Step 4 discipline actions (Chapter 5.7).

Vice President

- Accountable for implementation across operations. Resolves resource conflicts in favor of safe work.
- Sits on the review committee. Reviews the central safety log and program metrics with Corporate Safety.

Corporate Safety Officer

- IIPP Administrator. Maintains this manual, the module library, the central safety log, and the training matrix.
- Reviews every discipline action above Step 1 before issuance. Leads or oversees every incident investigation (Form 10A).
- Conducts unannounced site and facility inspections and tracks corrective actions to closure.

Entity Operations Leadership

- Builds safety into schedules, budgets, and manning. A plan that cannot be executed safely is not an approved plan.
- Consulted on job impact before committee decisions are final (Chapter 5.7).

Superintendents and Foremen

- Own safety on their sites and crews. Lead pre-task planning, run tailboards, conduct inspections, enforce the rules on the spot, and document coaching in the central log.
- A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation (Chapter 5.8).

Site Safety Officers (where assigned)

- Support the superintendent with inspections, orientations, monitoring, and documentation. Assignment of an SSO does not transfer the superintendent's responsibility.

Fleet Manager

- Authority for vehicle and DOT matters under the Fleet Management Program. Chapter 25 governs the interface.

Every Employee

- Work by this manual and the 7 Rules. Inspect your equipment. Plan your task. Wear your PPE.
- Report hazards, injuries, near misses, and damage the same shift. Stop work that is not safe.

2.3 Competent Persons

Work that requires a competent person under Title 8 (excavation, scaffolds, fall protection, and others per the entity's modules) is not performed until a designated competent person is on site with the authority to stop the work and correct the hazard. Designations are made in writing by Corporate Safety based on training and demonstrated experience, and are tracked in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety. Anyone who needs to confirm a designation contacts Corporate Safety. Holding a card does not make a person competent; the designation does.

CHAPTER 3. INJURY AND ILLNESS PREVENTION PROGRAM

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3203).

3.1 Purpose

This chapter is the Injury and Illness Prevention Program required by Title 8, California Code of Regulations, Section 3203. It is the framework every other chapter hangs on: who is responsible, how hazards get found and fixed, how we communicate about safety, how incidents get investigated, and how training happens. If a question is not answered elsewhere in this manual, it is answered here.

3.2 Responsibility

The IIPP Administrator for The Hays Companies Group is the Corporate Safety Officer, Sergio Robles, with authority and responsibility for implementing and maintaining this program. Entity operations leadership, superintendents, and foremen implement it on every site, every shift. Every employee is responsible for working safely, following this manual, and reporting hazards. The named-person table for this entity, including the Administrator and designated competent persons, is in Appendix A.

3.3 Compliance

The system for ensuring employees comply with safe work practices is Chapter 5, Enforcement and Accountability: one standard, three tiers, four steps, applied identically to everyone. Compliance is also recognized: supervisors and Corporate Safety acknowledge crews and individuals who work safely, surface hazards, and stop work when conditions call for it. Safe work is a condition of employment.

3.4 Communication

Safety communication runs in both directions, in a form readily understandable by all affected employees, including Spanish where crews require it:

- Daily pre-task planning and tailboard meetings on every crew (Chapter 7).
- Toolbox talks at least weekly, documented with topic and attendance.
- Safety alerts issued by Corporate Safety after significant incidents, near misses, or regulatory changes.
- New-hire orientation and the condensed field handbook (Chapter 23).

- Direct access: any employee may raise any safety concern to any supervisor, Corporate Safety, or Human Resources, in any language, at any time.
- Anonymous reporting: employees may report hazards anonymously to Corporate Safety, by phone or through the posted safety QR code, which links to a report form that can be submitted anonymously and is delivered directly to Corporate Safety. No employee will be retaliated against for reporting a hazard or an injury, anonymously or by name (Chapter 5.3).

3.5 Hazard Identification and Periodic Inspections

Hazards are found on a schedule and whenever conditions change, not only after something goes wrong.

- Daily: the crew inspects the work area, tools, and equipment as part of pre-task planning. Equipment operators complete the daily equipment checklist before operation.
- Weekly: the superintendent or foreman conducts and documents a site inspection on the standard checklist.
- Monthly: yards, shops, and facilities are inspected on the facility checklist by the responsible manager.
- Periodic and unannounced: Corporate Safety inspects sites and facilities across the entity, prioritized by risk and incident history.
- Event-driven: inspections are performed whenever new substances, processes, equipment, or procedures are introduced, whenever a new or previously unrecognized hazard is reported, and after any incident or near miss.

Inspection records identify the site, the date, the inspector, the hazards found, and the correction status, and are retained per Chapter 9.

3.6 Incident Investigation

Every occupational injury, illness, near miss, and property or utility damage event is investigated under Chapter 8 on Form 10A. The investigation identifies what happened, why the system allowed it, and what will prevent it, and its corrective actions are tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.7 Hazard Correction

Hazards are corrected when found. Where correction takes time, interim protection is put in place immediately.

- Imminent hazard: work in the affected area stops now. Exposed employees are removed, and only employees necessary to correct the condition, with proper protection, may enter. Work does not resume until the hazard is corrected.
- Serious hazard: corrected before the affected work continues, and no later than the same shift.
- Other hazards: corrected on a documented schedule with a named owner, tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.8 Training and Instruction

Training is provided when the program is first established, to every new employee at orientation, to every employee given a new job assignment for which training has not been received, whenever new substances, processes, procedures, or equipment introduce a new hazard, whenever the Company is made aware of a new or previously unrecognized hazard, and to supervisors on the hazards of the work they direct. The role-based training matrix, refresher cadences, and verification requirements are in Chapter 23. Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time.

3.9 Records

IIPP records, including inspection records and training documentation, are maintained per Chapter 9. Inspection records are retained at least one year; training records at least three years, or longer where a specific standard requires it.

Version 1.0 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Maintained by Corporate Safety.

CHAPTER 4. CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Posted at each office location, or readily available with a posted notice of its location. It is entity-specific and speaks only in The Hays Companies Group's name, issued with this manual as the office Code of Safe Practices.

CHAPTER 5. ENFORCEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Entity manuals are generated from this master; do not edit entity copies directly.

5.1 Purpose and Principle

This chapter sets one standard for safety accountability. The same rules, the same tiers, and the same consequences apply to every employee of The Hays Companies Group, from a first-day laborer to the most senior superintendent, in every division and on every jobsite. Discipline under this chapter is corrective before it is punitive: the goal is that everyone goes home, every day. The Company distinguishes honest mistakes from risky drift and from conscious disregard, and it responds to each differently. What it does not do is look the other way.

This chapter works together with the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline). Nothing in this chapter creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment. The Company retains discretion under Handbook Section 8.5 to apply the level of corrective action appropriate to the facts and circumstances of each case.

5.2 The 7 Rules That Keep You Alive

Seven rules cover the hazards most likely to kill or seriously injure. They are posted at every jobsite and facility, issued on a wallet card to every field employee, and signed for at orientation.

1. Tie off above 6 feet. Every time.

Ladders, scaffolds, lifts, and roofs included. Anchor points rated for 5,000 pounds.

2. Lock it. Tag it. Try it.

Verify zero energy and apply your own lock and tag before working on any energized system.

3. Know your line of fire.

Never under a suspended load, never in a swing radius, never between moving equipment and a fixed object.

4. No trench entry without protection.

Five feet or deeper requires a competent person inspection, protective systems, and egress within 25 feet.

5. Live track and live traffic kill.

No one fouls a track or steps into a traffic lane until on-track safety or traffic control is established and the briefing is complete.

6. Seatbelts on. Spotter when backing. Phone down.

Every vehicle, every piece of mobile equipment, every shift. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or where vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

7. Show up ready to work.

Free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Disclose any medication that affects alertness before your shift.

5.3 Stop Work Authority and Anti-Retaliation

Every employee has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe is unsafe. Work does not resume until the condition is corrected and the person who stopped the work, or a supervisor, confirms it is safe to proceed. No employee will ever be disciplined, demoted, reassigned, or treated worse for stopping work in good faith, reporting a hazard, reporting an injury, or refusing unsafe work. Retaliation against an employee who exercises stop work authority or reports in good faith is itself a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

5.4 The Three Violation Tiers

Tier	Definition	Examples	Entry Point
Tier 1. Life-Critical	Conduct that could kill or seriously injure. Violations of the 7 Rules.	Untied at heights; LOTO bypass; line-of-fire violation; unprotected trench entry; fouling live track or traffic without protection; removing or disabling a safety device; working impaired.	Enters at Step 3. Reckless conduct enters at Step 4.
Tier 2. Major Operational	Serious failure of judgment, process, or care that creates significant risk, cost, or exposure. The test: did this violation, by itself, create real risk, cost, or exposure to the company, the public, or the crew — regardless of whether anyone got hurt or anything actually broke? If yes, it's Tier 2.	Negligent equipment damage with skipped procedure; operating outside qualifications; refusing PPE after correction; concealing damage or an incident; supervisor failure to enforce; retaliation-adjacent conduct.	Enters at Step 2.
Tier 3. Process	The daily disciplines that	Missed PPE; missed JHA	Enters at Step 1.

Compliance	prevent everything else. The test: did this violation weaken a safeguard or process step without creating risk, cost, or exposure on its own — something that only matters if something else also goes wrong? If yes, it's Tier 3.	or pre-task plan; missed equipment checklist; missed toolbox attendance; housekeeping after a request.	

Falsification of any safety record, inspection, timecard, or qualification document is treated outside the ordinary ladder: a single proven instance is grounds for termination regardless of tier.

5.5 Behavior Classification (Just Culture)

The tier sets the entry point. Before any Step 3 or Step 4 action, the review committee classifies the behavior. Same act, different intent, different response.

Classification	Meaning	Response
Human Error	An honest mistake by someone trying to do the right thing, often set up by a system, training, or tool gap.	Console the person. Fix the system. No discipline.
At-Risk Behavior	Drift from the rule because the risk was not seen, was rationalized, or had become normal on the crew. The most common finding.	Coach, document, retrain. The tier entry point applies. Repeat preventable events escalate per the rules in 5.6.
Reckless Behavior	Knew the rule, knew the risk, chose to ignore it.	Escalation above the entry point. Reckless Tier 1 conduct is grounds for termination.
No-Fault / System Failure	No employee behavior contribution: procedures were followed and the system still produced the outcome.	No discipline of any kind. The system is examined and fixed; the event is logged for trend analysis.

The substitution test: would three other employees with the same training, at the same skill level, in the same conditions, likely have made the same choice? If yes, the problem is the system and the fix is the system. If no, the classification above governs.

For Tier 1 violations, the Company may impose any step up to and including termination based on the totality of the circumstances, including the potential for harm, the vulnerability of the public or the crew, client and site requirements, and the employee's overall record. The tiers

describe the ordinary response; they do not limit the Company's discretion under Handbook Section 8.5.

5.6 The Four-Step Ladder

Step	Action	Approval Required
Step 1. Documented Coaching	The supervisor reports the event to the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift. The Corporate Safety Officer conducts and documents the coaching conversation with the employee, and logs it in the central safety log within 48 hours. Not a formal write-up. Documented coaching is conducted by the Corporate Safety Officer only; no one else delivers it.	Corporate Safety Officer
Step 2. Written Warning	Formal written warning, signed by the employee, filed in the personnel file and the central log. Retraining assigned within 14 days is paid time.	Review Committee
Step 3. Stand-Down (1 to 3 days, unpaid for non-exempt employees)	Removal from work. Documented re-orientation with Corporate Safety before return. A subsequent violation within 12 months results in termination. For exempt employees, unpaid suspension is structured in full workweek increments or as accrued PTO use, per wage and hour law.	Review Committee
Step 4. Termination	Separation after investigation. Final pay and separation requirements per state law.	Review Committee, with HR execution

Prior record. An employee's record includes all documented discipline and preventable incidents, including those documented before this program's effective date. The Review Committee considers the full record on every recommendation of Step 2 or higher. At adoption of this revision, Corporate Safety and Human Resources enter existing documented discipline and preventable incidents from the prior 12 months into the central safety log as opening history.

Repeat events. A second preventable Tier 1 or Tier 2 event within 12 months enters the ladder one step above the tier entry point. A third preventable event within 12 months is referred to the Review Committee for a termination decision, regardless of tier. Event counts are tracked in the central safety log.

Introductory period. During an employee's first 90 days of employment, the progressive ladder does not bind the Company. Any Tier 1 or Tier 2 event classified as At-Risk or Reckless Behavior during the introductory period is routed directly to the Review Committee as an employment suitability decision, with termination available at entry. Events classified No-Fault / System Failure or Human Error, stopping work in good faith, and honest reporting are never grounds for action under this paragraph, during the introductory period or at any other time.

Active Steps 1 through 3 reset after 12 months of violation-free work, tracked in the central safety log. Time spent in required retraining is paid for all employees.

5.7 The Review Committee

One committee reviews every proposed Step 3 and Step 4 action, every introductory period routing and third-event referral under Section 5.6, and every driving event escalation under the Driver Acceptability Standards: the Chief Executive Officer, the Vice President, the Corporate Safety Officer, and the Human Resources Manager, or their written designees. Field operations leadership is consulted on job impact before decisions are final but is not a required approver. No Step 3 or Step 4 action is issued without committee review, and no supervisor may promise or impose one on their own. Corporate Safety reviews every action above Step 1 before it is issued to keep classification and consequences consistent across all divisions and entities.

5.8 Supervisors Are Accountable for Enforcement

A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation. Enforcement is not optional and it is not personal. Supervisors document coaching conversations, correct hazards on the spot, and escalate what they cannot correct. Leadership backs supervisors who hold the line.

5.9 Driving Events

Driving and vehicle events are governed by the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix and the Fleet Management Program. Where a driving event is also a violation of the 7 Rules (for example, seatbelt not worn, handheld phone in motion, or operating impaired), the safety tier sets the minimum response and the review committee resolves both tracks in a single decision. One event, one committee, one outcome.

5.10 Employees Covered by a Collective Bargaining Agreement

No employees of The Hays Companies Group are currently covered by a collective bargaining agreement. This section is retained as the group framework and activates by skin reissue if that changes.

The safety rules in this manual, the 7 Rules, stop work authority, and the violation tiers apply identically to every employee, including employees covered by a collective bargaining

agreement. For CBA-covered employees, the procedure for imposing discipline, including notice, representation, and grievance rights, follows the applicable agreement. Nothing in any agreement limits the Company's authority to remove an employee from work immediately for a safety violation pending the contractual process. Where this chapter and a CBA procedure differ, the CBA procedure governs the process; the safety standard itself does not change.

Not applicable at issue.

5.11 The Central Safety Log

Every coaching, warning, stand-down, termination, incident, near miss, and stop work event is entered in the central safety log maintained by Corporate Safety within 48 hours. Corporate Safety keeps the log current. Monthly, Corporate Safety provides the log to the Review Committee with an analysis of trends and recommended actions to prevent what the log shows developing.

5.12 Equipment Damage

All damage to equipment, vehicles, tools, and property, whether owned, rented, client, or third party, is reported, investigated, and resolved under this section. The purpose is the same as the rest of this program: find and fix the system, hold knowing violations accountable, and never give anyone a reason to hide damage.

Reporting. All damage, however minor, is reported to the supervisor and the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift it occurs or is discovered (Chapter 8.1). A scratch reported is a repair; a scratch hidden is a falsification problem. Damaged equipment that could affect safe operation is taken out of service, tagged, and not returned until cleared. Damage involving a utility, the public, a client's property, or a regulator follows Chapter 8 in full.

Investigation. Damage events are investigated on Form 10A with a Form 10A-1 for each employee involved. The first question is always behavioral: were all applicable procedures followed? If yes, the event is No-Fault / System Failure: no discipline of any kind. The damage is logged, the system is examined, and corrective actions are assigned with named owners and due dates. If a procedure was not followed, the behavior is classified under this chapter: human error, at-risk behavior (coached by the Corporate Safety Officer, documented, retrained), or reckless conduct (tier assignment and the discipline ladder).

A violation of a 7 Rules requirement in a damage event (seatbelt, spotter, raised bed, lockout) is a Tier 1 matter regardless of the damage amount. Concealing damage, or falsifying an inspection, checklist, or record connected to it, is outside the ladder entirely: a single proven instance is a terminable offense, routed directly to the Review Committee.

Discipline keys to behavior, never to the repair bill. A $50,000 failure with every procedure followed is a No-Fault system event. A $200 mirror knocked off while backing without a spotter

is a 7 Rules violation. Repair costs are recorded in the central safety log for trend analysis only. The moment discipline follows dollars, small damage disappears underground and surfaces later as big damage.

Tracking. Every damage event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours with unit, description, estimated cost, classification, and corrective actions. Repeat events on the same unit, crew, or cause are flagged in the monthly Review Committee report with recommended prevention actions. Vehicle events that are also DOT matters follow the Fleet Management Program: one event, one investigation, one committee.

Version 1.1 | Effective October 13, 2026 | Maintained by Corporate Safety.

CHAPTER 6. STOP WORK AUTHORITY

This chapter expands the standard set in Chapter 5.3 into the working procedure.

6.1 The Authority

Every employee of The Hays Companies Group, regardless of position, seniority, or trade, has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe presents a danger to any person, the public, or a utility. The authority extends to stopping the work of other crews and, on our sites, the work of subcontractors. No permission is needed. No justification beyond a good-faith concern is required. A stop work call made in good faith is never wrong, even when the concern turns out to be unfounded.

6.2 How Work Gets Stopped

- Say it plainly: STOP WORK. Address the person in the hazard first, the supervisor second.
- Make the area safe. Remove people from exposure. Do not attempt to correct an imminent hazard alone or without protection.
- Notify the supervisor immediately. The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for any stop involving a life-critical hazard, a utility, the public, or a subcontractor.

6.3 Restart

Work resumes only when all three are true: the condition is corrected or controlled, the person who stopped the work or the supervisor confirms it is safe to proceed, and the crew is briefed on what changed. If the person who stopped the work and the supervisor disagree on whether it is safe to resume, the work stays stopped and the question goes to Corporate Safety. Corporate Safety's call is final.

6.4 Documentation

Every stop work event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours: who stopped it, what the condition was, how it was corrected, and when work resumed. Stop work events are reviewed for system lessons, never for blame. Crews and individuals who make good stop work calls are recognized for them.

6.5 No Retaliation

Chapter 5.3 applies in full. Retaliation against any person for stopping work or raising a concern in good faith is a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

Version 1.0 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Maintained by Corporate Safety.

CHAPTER 7. PRE-TASK PLANNING

Not carried as a daily requirement in the office subset. Non-routine tasks with real hazards (moves, storage work at height, event setup, facility repairs) receive a documented hazard review before the work, per Module OFC-01 Section 4.

CHAPTER 8. INCIDENT INVESTIGATION AND REPORTING

Form 10A is the standard investigation record group-wide.

8.1 What Gets Reported, and When

Every employee reports the following to their supervisor immediately, and in no case later than the end of the shift in which it occurred. The supervisor reports to Corporate Safety the same shift.

- Any injury or illness, however minor. First aid cases included.
- Any near miss: an event that could have caused injury, damage, or a utility strike under slightly different circumstances.
- Any utility contact or damage, any equipment or property damage, and any vehicle event.
- Any fire, spill, or release.
- Any contact from a regulator, and any incident involving the public or a client's facilities.

Late reporting is a Tier 2 violation. Concealing an incident is treated at Step 3 minimum, and falsifying a report is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4. Reporting an incident honestly is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

8.2 Immediate Response and Scene Preservation

- People first: care for the injured, remove others from exposure, and call 911 where warranted. First aid and medical services per Chapter 14.
- Make the scene safe, then leave it alone. After a serious incident, nothing is moved, altered, or cleaned up except to rescue, prevent further harm, or as directed by responders, until Corporate Safety releases the scene.
- Photograph conditions as found. Identify witnesses and separate them for statements while memory is fresh.

8.3 External Reporting

Corporate Safety makes all regulatory notifications. In California, any serious injury or illness, or any death, is reported to Cal/OSHA immediately and in no case more than 8 hours after the Company knows or should have known of it (T8 CCR 342). Utility damage notifications, environmental releases, DOT-reportable events, and client notifications follow the applicable module and contract. No employee makes a regulatory or media statement about an incident; inquiries go to Corporate Safety and leadership.

8.4 The Investigation

Every reportable event under 8.1 is investigated on Form 10A. Corporate Safety leads or oversees the investigation; the supervisor of the affected work participates. Investigations begin within 24 hours and are completed promptly, with serious incidents given priority over all other safety work. The investigation establishes the facts, the sequence, the direct causes, and the system causes: what about our planning, training, equipment, supervision, or procedures allowed this to happen.

Behavior found in the investigation is classified under Chapter 5.5 before any discipline is proposed. The investigation answers what happened and why. The review committee answers what follows from it.

8.5 Corrective Actions

Every investigation produces corrective actions with a named owner and a due date, entered in the central safety log and tracked to closure. Corrective actions that change a rule, a procedure, or a module trigger an update to this manual under the version control process, and a safety alert to affected crews where warranted. Any module touched by an incident investigation is reviewed immediately.

8.6 Post-Incident Testing and Claims

Post-incident drug and alcohol testing is governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including its DOT riders. Testing decisions follow that policy's criteria, never assumption or accusation. Injury claims, medical management, and return to work are handled under Chapter 24 and the claims protocol; supervisors report claims information to Corporate Safety and HR only.

Version 1.0 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Maintained by Corporate Safety.

CHAPTER 9. RECORDKEEPING AND RECORDS ACCESS

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 14300 series, 3204). 1020.

9.1 Principle

Records are how this program proves itself: to a regulator, to a carrier, to a court, and to ourselves. A record that does not exist, cannot be found, or was filled in after the fact is worse than no program at all. Every record required by this manual has an owner, a home, and a retention period. Falsification of any record is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4.

9.2 Injury and Illness Recordkeeping

- Corporate Safety maintains the OSHA 300 Log and 301 incident reports for The Hays Companies Group. Recordable cases are entered within 7 calendar days of learning of them. Recordability decisions are made by Corporate Safety, never by a supervisor in the field.
- The 300A annual summary is certified by entity executive leadership and posted at each establishment from February 1 through April 30, and submitted electronically where size and industry thresholds require it.
- Logs and summaries are retained 5 years and updated when case status changes.
- Privacy cases are handled per the regulation: the name comes off the log, the case stays on it.

9.3 Program Records and Retention

Record	Owner	Retention
JHA/PTP forms, tailboards, toolbox talks	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Inspection records (site, facility, equipment)	Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Training and orientation records, acknowledgments, certifications	Corporate Safety training matrix	3 years minimum, and for the duration of the certification
Incident investigations (Form 10A) and corrective actions	Corporate Safety, central safety log	5 years
Discipline records under Chapter 5	HR personnel file and central safety log	Per HR retention schedule
Employee exposure and medical records	HR / Corporate Safety, confidential	Duration of employment plus 30 years (T8 3204)
Permits (confined space, hot work, excavation, client permits)	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year, or per the governing standard

9.4 Employee Access

Any employee, former employee, or their designated representative may request their own exposure and medical records under T8 3204 and the injury log entries the regulation entitles them to see. Requests go to Corporate Safety or HR and are fulfilled within the regulatory timelines. Medical records are confidential and are released only as the regulation and the employee's authorization allow.

Version 1.0 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Maintained by Corporate Safety.

The Hays Companies Group

CHAPTER 10. HAZARD COMMUNICATION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 5194). 1200.

10.1 Purpose and Scope

Employees have the right to know what chemicals they work with and around, what those chemicals can do to them, and how to protect themselves. This program covers every hazardous chemical used or stored by The Hays Companies Group: fuels, oils, solvents, adhesives, concrete and masonry products, compressed gases, paints and coatings, and shop chemicals. It applies on our sites, in our yards and shops, and in our vehicles.

10.2 Chemical Inventory and Safety Data Sheets

- Corporate Safety maintains the master chemical inventory for the entity. Superintendents and yard managers keep their location list current; no new chemical is brought into use until its SDS is on file and any needed controls are in place.
- An SDS for every chemical at a location is accessible to every employee on that location during every shift, without asking permission: in the site or shop SDS binder, or electronically where reliable access exists, with a backup when it does not.
- If an SDS is missing, the chemical is not used until it is obtained.

10.3 Labels

- Manufacturer containers keep their labels, legible and intact. A container with a damaged or missing label is taken out of service until relabeled.
- A compliant label includes six elements: product identifier, signal word (Danger or Warning), hazard statement(s), pictogram(s), precautionary statement(s), and the supplier's name, address, and phone number. A label missing any of these is treated the same as a damaged or missing label under this section.
- Secondary containers (spray bottles, fuel cans, small mix containers) are labeled with the product identity and hazard warnings. The only exception is a container used immediately and completely by the person who filled it, within the shift.
- Fuel and chemical transfer containers meet the applicable container standards. Food and drink containers are never used for chemicals. Ever.

10.4 Training

Every employee is trained at orientation and whenever a new hazard is introduced: how to read a label and an SDS, the physical and health hazards of the chemical categories in their work —

including simple asphyxiants and combustible dust where present, such as confined space atmospheres and silica-generating work — how to detect a release, the protective measures and PPE required, and where the inventory and SDS collection live. Training is in a language and manner the employee understands, and is documented per Chapter 9.

10.5 Non-Routine Tasks and Multi-Employer Sites

- Before a non-routine task involving chemicals (tank or equipment cleaning, demolition of coated or treated materials, unexpected containers found in an excavation), the supervisor and Corporate Safety review the hazards and controls at the pre-task plan. Unknown containers or suspect materials stop the work until identified.
- On multi-employer sites, we inform other employers of the hazardous chemicals our work exposes their people to, provide SDS access, and obtain the same from them. Their chemical hazards go into our crew's pre-task plan.
- On client-controlled sites, the client's hazard communication program applies alongside this chapter; the stricter provision governs.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: SDS accessible without delay, labels intact on primary and secondary containers, non-routine task hazards reviewed before work starts, and training documented per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 11. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

The entity PPE table and any FR/arc-rated requirements are set out in Appendix A and work modules.

11.1 Principle

PPE is the last line of defense, never the first. Hazards are eliminated, substituted, engineered out, or controlled by procedure before PPE is relied on. But the last line holds: where PPE is required, wearing it correctly is a condition of being on the work, and a missed-PPE violation enters the discipline ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

11.2 Hazard Assessment

Corporate Safety certifies a written PPE hazard assessment for the entity's operations, by work type, reviewed annually and whenever the work changes. The assessment drives the entity PPE table in the skin. The daily JHA/PTP is the task-level assessment: it names the PPE for that day's work, including anything above the standard set.

11.3 Minimum Field Standard

On every jobsite and in every yard and shop work area, unless Appendix A or a work module sets more:

- Hard hat, ANSI Z89.1.
- Safety glasses, ANSI Z87.1. Face shield over them for cutting, grinding, chipping, and chemical splash.
- High-visibility apparel, Class 2 minimum; Class 3 for night work and where the traffic control module requires it.
- Safety-toe boots in serviceable condition, ASTM F2413.
- Gloves matched to the task: cut-rated for handling, chemical-rated for chemicals, leather for general work.
- Hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment. Respiratory, fall, FR, and arc-rated equipment per the applicable work module and the entity table.

11.4 Provision, Fit, and Care

- The Company provides required PPE at no cost to employees, in the sizes its people need. Prescription-compatible eye protection is accommodated.

- PPE is inspected by the wearer before each use. Damaged, expired, or contaminated PPE is removed from service and replaced; there is no discipline for asking for replacement gear, only for working without it.
- Fall protection, respirators, and other life-critical PPE are inspected, fitted, and maintained per their governing modules, including fit testing and medical evaluation where required.

11.5 Enforcement

Supervisors verify PPE at the tailboard and throughout the shift. Visitors and subcontractor personnel on our sites meet the same minimums or leave the work area.

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CHAPTER 12. HEAT ILLNESS PREVENTION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3395 outdoor; T8 CCR 3396 indoor where applicable). The Fed OSHA base text carries the equivalent program with AZ addendum triggers.

12.1 Purpose

Heat kills workers in our climate and our trades every year, and it is entirely preventable. This chapter is the entity's written Heat Illness Prevention Plan. It is available at every worksite, and the supervisor running the work is responsible for executing it every hot day, without being asked.

12.2 Water

Fresh, pure, suitably cool drinking water is available at no cost, as close as practicable to the work, in quantities sufficient for at least one quart per employee per hour for the full shift. Supervisors encourage frequent drinking; nobody waits until they are thirsty. Water service is checked at the start of the shift and replenished before it runs low.

12.3 Shade

When the outdoor temperature exceeds 80 degrees, shade is up and available: enough for all employees on a rest or meal break to sit in full shade without crowding, as close as practicable to the work. Below 80 degrees, shade is provided on request. Employees who need a preventative cool-down rest take one, are monitored, and are never ordered back to work until symptoms are gone; a cool-down rest is paid time and lasts no less than 5 minutes in the shade.

12.4 Acclimatization

New employees, employees returning from time away, and everyone during a heat wave are at the highest risk. Supervisors closely observe new and newly assigned employees for their first 14 days of hot work, and all employees during a heat wave or the first hot spell of the season. Workload and pace are adjusted while bodies adapt. Being new is a risk factor, and the schedule respects it.

12.5 High-Heat Procedures (95 Degrees and Above)

- Pre-shift meeting covering the high-heat plan, water, symptoms, and the buddy system.
- Effective observation of every employee: a mandatory buddy system, supervisor observation of 20 or fewer employees, or regular communication with anyone working alone.

- Effective communication maintained with every employee (voice, radio, or observation; a phone only where reception is reliable).
- Reminders to drink water throughout the shift, and rest breaks taken in shade.

12.6 Emergency Response

- Every crew knows the signs: heavy sweating, cramps, headache, and fatigue mean heat exhaustion; confusion, staggering, hot dry skin, or collapse mean heat stroke, and heat stroke is a 911 call, immediately.
- A sick employee is never left alone and never sent home or to their vehicle unaccompanied. Move them to shade, cool them aggressively (water, wet cloth, airflow), and get medical help per the severity.
- Every site's emergency information (Chapter 7 pre-task plan) includes clear directions for responders to the work location, especially remote and right-of-way work.

12.7 Indoor Heat

Scope and Definition

This section applies to indoor places of employment: any space under a ceiling or overhead covering that restricts airflow, enclosed along its entire perimeter by walls, doors, windows, dividers, or other barriers that restrict airflow, whether open or closed. Shops, warehouses, enclosed structures, and covered spaces that meet this description are indoor for purposes of this section, regardless of how they're used. A covered structure that is not enclosed along its entire perimeter is not indoor; it follows the outdoor provisions in Sections 12.2 through 12.6 instead. Yard and shop managers determine which of their spaces meet this definition and document that determination.

The Two Triggers

Indoor heat illness prevention has two levels, and they are not the same obligation:

At 82 degrees or above, when employees are present, the baseline requirements apply: water, a cool-down area, effective emergency response, and training.

At 87 degrees or above, or at 82 degrees where employees wear clothing that restricts heat removal or work in a high-radiant-heat area, the full requirements apply: everything in the baseline, plus temperature and heat index monitoring, recordkeeping, the controls hierarchy in Part E, and written indoor heat illness prevention measures for that space.

A space that only ever reaches the first threshold does not automatically require the second tier's controls or monitoring. A space that reaches the second threshold requires both.

Water and Cool-Down Areas

Fresh, pure, suitably cool drinking water is available at no cost, as close as practicable to the work, per the same standard as Section 12.2.

A cool-down area is maintained below 82 degrees, shielded from direct sunlight and radiant heat sources, sized for the number of employees who might use it at one time, and located close

enough to be practical. Employees who take a preventative cool-down rest are monitored and are never ordered back before symptoms resolve, per the same standard as Section 12.3.

Monitoring and Recordkeeping

Where a work area meets the 87-degree trigger (or the qualifying 82-degree conditions in Part B), the supervisor:

Measures and records temperature and heat index in that work area.

Identifies and evaluates other environmental risk factors for heat illness present in that space (radiant heat sources, humidity, air movement, clothing/PPE requirements).

Keeps those records available at the site.

Controls Hierarchy

Where the 87-degree trigger applies, controls are applied in this order:

Engineering controls first: reduce and maintain temperature and heat index below 87 degrees, or below 82 degrees where employees wear heat-restrictive clothing or work in a high-radiant-heat area. Fans, ventilation, insulation, spot cooling, and isolating process heat sources are typical measures.

Administrative controls, where engineering controls alone are not sufficient: adjusted work/rest schedules, rotation, and rescheduling heat-generating tasks.

Personal heat-protective equipment, only where the employer demonstrates that feasible engineering and administrative controls do not sufficiently minimize the risk, and only to the extent equipment is feasible for the task.

Written Indoor Heat Illness Prevention Measures

For each indoor space meeting the 87-degree trigger, the supervisor maintains a written record of: which controls from Part E are in place, who is responsible for implementing them, and how compliance is verified. This is reviewed and updated when conditions or the space itself change.

Acclimatization and Training

The acclimatization protections in Section 12.4 apply to employees newly assigned to hot indoor work the same way they apply to outdoor work: close observation for the first 14 days, and adjusted workload and pace while the body adapts.

Training under Section 12.8 includes, for employees who may work in indoor heat: how to identify whether a space is indoor under Part A, the two-trigger structure in Part B, the specific controls in place at their facility under Part E, and the vehicle/container exception in Part G.

12.8 Training

Every employee and supervisor is trained on this chapter before hot work, including risk factors, the Company's procedures, the importance of water and acclimatization, symptom recognition, and emergency response. Supervisors are additionally trained on their monitoring and response duties and on how weather triggers each procedure.

CHAPTER 13. EMERGENCY ACTION AND FIRE PROTECTION

Facility-specific plans and maps are set out in Appendix A.

13.1 Scope

This chapter covers emergencies at fixed facilities (offices, yards, shops) and on jobsites: fire, medical emergency, severe weather, earthquake, utility emergencies, and any event requiring evacuation. Site-specific emergency information for field work lives in the daily pre-task plan (Chapter 7); this chapter sets the standard that plan must meet.

13.2 Emergency Action Plan

- Every facility has a posted evacuation map, designated exit routes kept clear at all times, a muster point, and a way to account for everyone on the property, including visitors.
- Every jobsite tailboard establishes the same three things daily: how the alarm is raised, where people go, and who accounts for the crew and calls 911.
- Alarm and notification: any employee who discovers an emergency raises the alarm first by the fastest means, then acts. On multi-employer sites, our alarm reaches the other employers' crews and theirs reaches ours; the controlling contractor's system governs.
- After any evacuation, nobody re-enters until the incident commander or responding agency clears it. Headcount discrepancies are reported to responders immediately; employees do not re-enter to search.
- Corporate Safety designates a person by name and title responsible for maintaining this chapter's plan and answering employee questions about it, and a person by name and title at each facility responsible for maintaining equipment that controls ignition sources and fuel hazards (fueling stations, heat-producing equipment, flammable storage). Both are named in the facility's Appendix A package.

13.3 Utility Emergencies

A struck gas line, downed or damaged electrical line, or damaged pressurized main is treated as a life threat, not a repair problem. Evacuate upwind and uphill for gas, establish distance for electrical (assume energized, minimum 30 feet, more for high voltage), eliminate ignition sources, call 911 and the utility owner, and keep the public back. The crew protects people and the perimeter; the utility owner makes it safe. Detailed procedures are in the underground utilities and electrical work modules.

13.4 Severe Weather and Earthquake

- Lightning within 10 miles (flash-to-bang 30 seconds or less) suspends exposed elevated work, crane operations, and open-field work until 30 minutes after the last strike.
- High wind suspends crane, hoisting, and panel operations per the equipment manual and the lift plan. Rain that defeats excavation protection or traffic control visibility suspends that work under the governing module.
- Earthquake: drop, cover, hold on inside; in the open, move clear of structures, poles, and lines. After shaking stops, evacuate per the plan, account for everyone, and treat every utility as suspect until inspected.

13.5 Fire Prevention and Protection

- Fuels, flammables, and compressed gases are stored, separated, and secured per the applicable standards; ignition sources are controlled around them, and refueling is done engine-off with bonding where required.
- Hot work (welding, cutting, grinding near combustibles) is performed under the hot work module with a fire watch where required.
- Portable extinguishers are provided at facilities, on jobsites, in company vehicles per the fleet standard, and on equipment where the module requires them: mounted, charged, accessible, visually checked monthly, and serviced annually.
- Extinguishers are distributed so travel distance never exceeds 75 feet for Class A hazards (ordinary combustibles) or 50 feet for Class B hazards (flammable liquids); Class C areas follow whichever of those patterns fits the underlying A or B hazard. Extinguisher type is matched to the hazard present — a Class B-rated unit alone is not sufficient where ordinary combustibles are also present.
- Employees are trained at orientation on extinguisher use and its limit: small, contained, early-stage fires only, with an exit at your back. Anything more is an evacuation and a 911 call. Fighting the fire is never required.
- Oily rags, packaging, sawdust, and other combustible waste are collected in covered metal containers and removed from the work area at the end of each shift; accumulation is not allowed to build up around ignition sources, exits, or extinguisher locations.

13.6 Drills and Review

Facilities conduct an evacuation drill at least annually, documented with date and attendance. The plan is reviewed after every drill, every real activation, and any facility change, and the lessons go into the master via the version control process. Every employee is trained on this chapter's plan before their first assignment, and retrained whenever their role changes in a way that affects their emergency duties or the plan itself changes. This is separate from and in addition to the annual evacuation drill.

CHAPTER 14. FIRST AID AND MEDICAL SERVICES

Designated clinics and facility postings are set out in Appendix A.

14.1 Trained Personnel

Every crew and every facility has ready access to a person currently certified in first aid and CPR. For field crews, that person is on the crew: certifications are tracked in the training matrix, planned into crew assignments by dispatch and the superintendent, and verified at pre-mobilization. Remote and right-of-way work is staffed so that trained response does not depend on outside help arriving quickly.

14.2 Supplies

- First aid kits sized to the crew are on every jobsite, in every crew truck per the fleet standard, and at every facility: inspected and restocked monthly and after every use, protected from dust and moisture, and matched to the hazards of the work per the modules (burn care, eye wash, trauma dressings where the work warrants).
- Where employees may be exposed to injurious corrosive materials, plumbed or portable eyewash meeting the standard is available at the work area, inspected on schedule.
- AEDs installed at facilities are inspected monthly and their locations posted.

14.3 Getting Help

- Every pre-task plan and every facility posting identifies: emergency numbers, the address or coordinates of the work, driving directions for responders, and the nearest emergency room and designated occupational clinic.
- Life threat, altered consciousness, uncontrolled bleeding, suspected spine injury, chest pain, heat stroke: call 911. Do not drive the person. For injuries below that line, a supervisor arranges transport to the designated clinic; an injured employee does not drive themselves.
- The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for every injury, however minor, per Chapter 8. First aid cases are logged even when no treatment beyond the kit is needed.

14.4 Bloodborne Pathogens

Employees designated as first aid responders and employees whose duties include cleanup of blood or bodily fluids are covered by the entity's bloodborne pathogens exposure control program: universal precautions, gloves and barriers in every kit, proper cleanup and disposal, hepatitis B vaccination offered per the standard, and immediate reporting and medical follow-

up for any exposure incident. Nobody cleans up blood bare-handed, and no exposure goes unreported.

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CHAPTER 15. FIT FOR DUTY, DRUG AND ALCOHOL, AND FATIGUE

The Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy is the single source of truth for all testing; this chapter does not duplicate it.

15.1 Fit for Duty

Rule 7 of the 7 Rules: show up ready to work, free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Fitness for duty is a condition of every shift, and it covers prescription and over-the-counter medication: any employee taking a medication that can affect alertness, judgment, coordination, or reaction time discloses it to their supervisor before the shift. The conversation is about the effect, never the diagnosis; medical information stays confidential with HR. Work assignments are adjusted while the effect lasts, and disclosure is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

15.2 Drug and Alcohol Policy

All drug and alcohol requirements, prohibitions, and testing (pre-employment, reasonable suspicion, post-incident, random, and return-to-duty, including DOT programs under 49 CFR Part 382 and any FRA or PHMSA riders that apply to the entity's work) are governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy. That policy is the single source of truth. Where this manual and that policy touch the same subject, that policy governs the testing process and this manual governs the safety consequence: working impaired is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5, and refusal to test is treated as the policy provides.

Supervisors are trained to recognize the signs of impairment and to act on them: an employee reasonably suspected of impairment is removed from work immediately, not sent to their vehicle and not left operating anything, and the reasonable suspicion process in the policy is followed the same shift.

15.3 Fatigue

Fatigue impairs like alcohol does, and it is managed like the hazard it is:

- Scheduling: work hours, night work, and consecutive days are planned with fatigue in mind. Hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers per the Fleet Management Program; extended shifts elsewhere get supervisor attention, not autopilot approval.
- Self-declaration: an employee too fatigued to work safely says so to their supervisor, before the shift or during it. A good-faith fatigue declaration is never disciplined; the response is an

assignment adjustment, rest, or a safe way home. Nobody drives home dangerously tired because they were afraid to say it.

- Night work: lighting, task rotation, and check-ins per the applicable module. Supervisors watch their crews for fatigue the same way they watch for heat illness.

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CHAPTER 16. HOUSEKEEPING AND WALKING-WORKING SURFACES

Slips, trips, and struck-by events are among this group's most frequent injuries; this chapter is a working control set, not a slogan.

16.1 The Standard

A clean site is a safe site, and it is also the public face of the Company. Housekeeping is part of the work, built into every task, every crew, every day. Clean as you go: debris, scrap, and packaging are removed as they are generated, not at the end of the week. The last hour of demobilization includes leaving the area clean.

16.2 Access and Walking Surfaces

- Walkways, stairs, ramps, and access routes are kept clear of materials, cords, hoses, tools, and mud buildup. A blocked exit route is corrected now, not noted for later.
- Cords and hoses crossing walkways are elevated, ramped, or routed around; crossing traffic areas, they are protected. Ground conditions (mud, ice, standing water, uneven backfill) are corrected, covered, or barricaded and lit.
- Holes and floor openings are covered per the fall protection module: secured, marked, and rated for the load, never a loose sheet of plywood.
- Work areas, stairs, and access routes have adequate lighting for the shift being worked; night work lighting per the applicable module.

16.3 Materials and Struck-By

- Materials are staged stable, stacked per manufacturer limits, banded or blocked against shifting, clear of edges, openings, and traffic lanes, and never within the buffer of a traffic control zone or the influence line of an excavation.
- Nails and screws in stripped lumber are pulled or bent flat before stacking. Rebar and other impalement hazards are capped or covered where any person could fall onto them.
- Tools and materials are secured against falling when work occurs overhead; barricades and toe boards protect the level below, and hard hat areas are enforced under it.

16.4 Responsibility

The foreman owns the housekeeping of the work area, the superintendent owns the site, and the yard or shop manager owns the facility. Housekeeping is checked on every weekly

inspection, and a housekeeping deficiency left standing after a request enters the ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

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CHAPTER 17. MATERIAL HANDLING AND ERGONOMICS

Carried in the office subset through Module OFC-01 Sections 2 and 3: workstation ergonomics, office lifting, and the early-reporting rule. The Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program, effective October 15, 2026, governs in full for every Hays Group entity; for this entity the office and administration provisions apply (adjustable workstations set to the user, monitor and keyboard height, movement breaks, workstation evaluation on request or on report of discomfort) along with the same-day discomfort report and the no-retaliation rule in Section 10 of the Program. Corporate Safety owns the Program and its records.

CHAPTER 18. HAND AND POWER TOOLS

Trimmed in the office subset to Module OFC-01 Section 4: stepstools and storage access; office equipment in good condition per OFC-01 Section 5.

CHAPTER 19. LADDERS

Trimmed in the office subset to Module OFC-01 Section 4: stepstool or inspected ladder for storage access, three points of contact, never a chair, box, or desk.

CHAPTER 20. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION

This chapter summarizes the entity's standalone Workplace Violence Prevention Plan under California Labor Code 6401.9; the WVPP document governs in full.

20.1 Policy

The Hays Companies Group does not tolerate violence, threats, intimidation, or harassment on its worksites, in its facilities, or in its vehicles, whether from employees, subcontractors, clients, or the public. This applies to conduct in person, by phone, and online where it reaches the workplace. Weapons are prohibited on Company property and worksites except as the law requires the Company to allow.

20.2 What Gets Reported

Employees report every incident, threat, or credible concern to their supervisor, Corporate Safety, or HR, including the four types the law recognizes: violence by an outsider with criminal intent, by a client or member of the public, by a current or former employee, and by someone with a personal relationship to an employee. Public interaction is real exposure for our crews on roadways and rights-of-way: aggressive drivers, confrontations at closures, and threats at work areas are workplace violence incidents and are reported and logged the same as anything internal. Reports can be made without fear of retaliation, and no employee is disciplined for reporting in good faith or for leaving a situation they reasonably believed was dangerous.

20.3 Response and the Violent Incident Log

- Immediate danger: get to safety, call 911, then notify the supervisor. Nobody is expected to confront an aggressor over property or a traffic device.
- Every incident is investigated under the WVPP, and every workplace violence incident is entered in the violent incident log with the detail the statute requires, retained 5 years. Corrective actions (site changes, staffing, client escalation, law enforcement referral) are tracked to closure.
- Employee conduct found to violate this chapter is handled under Chapter 5 and the Employee Handbook; threats and violence enter the ladder at the top.

20.4 Training

Every employee is trained on the WVPP at orientation and annually: the plan, how to report, the hazards specific to their work including public interaction at traffic control and right-of-way locations, and how to respond. Training records per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 21. SHORT SERVICE EMPLOYEES

Client SSE programs (ISNetworld and contract exhibits) may set stricter ratios; the stricter rule governs per Chapter 1.

21.1 Who Is an SSE

A Short Service Employee is anyone with less than 6 months of service with the Company, and anyone with less than 6 months in a new craft, role, or entity, regardless of total experience. A 20-year operator new to our work is an SSE for our purposes: they know the machine, they do not yet know us. New employees are statistically at their highest risk of injury in their first months, and this chapter exists because of it.

21.2 The Orientation Gate

No SSE performs field work until orientation is complete: the condensed field handbook delivered and acknowledged, the 7 Rules signed for, entity and client credentials verified per the pre-mobilization requirements, and the training matrix items for the role completed. Orientation is a gate, never a formality, and dispatch does not assign an employee whose gate is open.

21.3 Mentoring and Identification

- Every SSE is assigned a mentor: an experienced crew member designated by the foreman, responsible for pairing with the SSE on tasks, checking understanding at the tailboard, and speaking up on their behalf.
- SSEs are visually identifiable on site per the entity standard (hard hat marking or equivalent) so every crew knows who is new. The marking is a signal for extra eyes, never a target; hazing of new employees is a conduct violation handled under the Handbook.
- Crew composition respects experience: supervisors plan crews so SSEs are distributed, not concentrated, and client SSE ratio limits are honored where they apply.

21.4 Graduation

SSE status ends when the time threshold passes and the foreman and Corporate Safety confirm the training matrix for the role is complete and performance in the field supports it. Concerns extend the mentoring period; a calendar date alone does not end it.

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CHAPTER 22. SUBCONTRACTOR SAFETY MANAGEMENT

Not carried. Facility vendors and contractors working in the office are coordinated by office management: certificate of insurance, check-in, work area protection, and the emergency plan briefed. Construction work at the office is contracted through an operating entity and follows its program.

CHAPTER 23. TRAINING AND ORIENTATION

The role-based training matrix is maintained alongside this chapter and loads per entity.

23.1 The System

Training here is a system with a gate, a matrix, and a record, not a stack of certificates. The gate is orientation: nobody works in the field without it. The matrix defines what every role must hold, initially and on refresh. The record proves it, per Chapter 9, and pre-mobilization verification checks it before a crew ships. Pre-mobilization qualification (ISNetworld, RWP and eRailSafe, client credentials) and field orientation are distinct steps: the first proves the gate is satisfied, the second delivers the site and the life-critical subset to the person standing on it.

23.2 Orientation

- Every new hire, rehire, and inter-entity transfer completes entity orientation before field assignment: this manual's field layer (the condensed handbook), the 7 Rules with signed acknowledgment, the Employee Safety Acknowledgment, stop work authority, reporting duties, PPE issue, and the IIPP basics of Chapter 3.
- Orientation is delivered in a language and manner the employee understands, Spanish included where crews require it, with comprehension checked, not assumed.

23.3 The Training Matrix

The matrix maps every role to its required training: regulatory (per this manual and its work sections), certification (operator cards, ATSSA for flagging work, competent person designations, first aid/CPR coverage), client-required (RWP, eRailSafe, client orientations), and refreshers with their cadences. Corporate Safety owns the matrix, tracks expirations, and flags lapses to dispatch and supervisors before they become field problems. An expired requirement means no assignment to the affected work until it is current.

23.4 Delivery and Verification

- Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time, for every employee, always.
- Operating credentials require demonstration, not just attendance: operator cards and competent person designations are issued on evaluated performance per their programs.
- Toolbox talks (weekly minimum) and tailboards (daily) are the field refreshers that keep the formal training alive; both are documented with topic and attendance.
- Training effectiveness is checked in the field: inspections and investigations that find a knowledge gap trigger retraining and a matrix review, per the version control process.

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CHAPTER 24. RETURN TO WORK

The Return to Work Program document governs in full; this chapter states the entity's commitment and the field interface.

24.1 Philosophy

An injured employee is still our employee. The Company's Return to Work Program exists to keep people connected to work, income, and crew while they recover: transitional and modified duty is offered wherever medically appropriate work exists, matched to written restrictions, at no loss of dignity. Staying at work and returning early to real, useful, restriction-compliant tasks produces better medical outcomes than sitting at home, and the Company plans modified assignments the way it plans any other work.

24.2 How It Runs

- Medical care and claims initiation follow Chapter 14 and the claims protocol; the designated clinic is provided the essential functions of the job so restrictions come back specific, not generic.
- HR and Corporate Safety coordinate every restriction with the supervisor. A modified assignment honors the restrictions exactly: a supervisor never asks, hints, or allows an employee to work outside written restrictions, and an employee reports any task that conflicts with theirs. Violations of restrictions are treated as the safety issue they are.
- Modified duty is reviewed at every medical re-evaluation until full release. Communication with the recovering employee is regular and goes through HR and the supervisor; nobody disappears into a claim.
- Filing a claim or accepting modified duty is never retaliated against, period.

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CHAPTER 25. DRIVING AND FLEET SAFETY

The Fleet Management Program, the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix, and field procedures P-1 through P-3 are the single source of truth for fleet, DOT, and driver qualification matters; this chapter is the safety manual's interface to them.

25.1 The Rules Every Driver Follows

Rule 6 of the 7 Rules governs every Company vehicle and every piece of mobile equipment: seatbelts on, spotter when backing, phone down. In addition:

- Every occupant belted before the vehicle moves. No exceptions, no short trips.
- No handheld phone use in motion; hands-free minimized and never in complex driving. A call, text, or navigation entry can wait for a stopped, parked vehicle.
- Backing gets a spotter where one is available, and a walk-around when alone. Pull-through and first-move-forward parking are standard practice.
- Speed and following distance matched to conditions, loads secured per the applicable module before the vehicle moves, and impaired or dangerously fatigued driving prohibited under Chapter 15.
- Journey management for long hauls and remote work: route, fuel, rest, and check-in planned before departure per the fleet procedures.

25.2 Authority and Qualification

The Fleet Manager is the authority for vehicle assignment, maintenance, DOT compliance, telematics, and driver qualification under the Fleet Management Program. Only authorized, qualified drivers operate Company vehicles; CDL, medical card, and DOT requirements are tracked under that program, and hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers. Vehicle defects are reported per the fleet inspection procedures, and a vehicle with a safety defect does not roll.

25.3 Events

Every vehicle event (collision, citation, telematics escalation, damage) is reported the same shift under Chapter 8 and handled under the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix. Where an event is also a 7 Rules violation, Chapter 5.9 applies: one event, one committee, one outcome.

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APPENDIX A. ENTITY INFORMATION AND DESIGNATED PERSONS

THG CORP

A1. Entity Identity

Field	Entry
Legal name	The Hays Companies Group
Contractor license(s)	Not applicable
States of operation	California

A2. Named Persons

Role	Name	Function
Chief Executive Officer	Kirby Hays	Review Committee
Vice President	Karun Mani	Review Committee
Corporate Safety Officer / IIPP Administrator	Sergio Robles	Review Committee; program administration
HR Manager	Desiree Tapia	Review Committee; discipline execution
Field Operations	Jerry Neuman	Advisory to Committee on field impact
Fleet Manager	Derek Alonso	Vehicle, DOT, and driver qualification authority

No entity-level operational roles are designated; program administration for this entity is carried by the corporate table above (Corporate Safety and HR).

Designated competent persons by discipline, first aid/CPR roster, and operator card holders are maintained in the training matrix by Corporate Safety. To confirm any designation, contact Corporate Safety.

A3. Facilities

Facility	Address
Corporate office	4181 Latham St, Riverside, CA 92501

A4. Chapter Inserts and Switches

Insert	Setting
Ch 5.10 CBA insert	OFF
Ch 22	OFF: facility vendors per CORE-OFC treatment
Ch 12	Indoor provisions on HVAC failure or any area at 82

	degrees; outdoor provisions for assigned outdoor tasks

A5. Entity PPE Table (additions to the Chapter 11 minimum)

Work	Additional PPE
Office tasks	Task-based per OFC-01
Jobsite visits	Hard hat, glasses, Class 2 hi-vis, proper footwear issued before the visit

A6. Work Sections in This Manual

A7. Medical and Posting Information

Posting Item	Entry
Designated occupational clinic(s)	Concentra Urgent Care, 1595 Spruce St Suite 150, Riverside, CA 92507
Nearest emergency room (per facility)	Riverside Community Hospital, 4445 Magnolia Ave, Riverside, CA 92501
Cal/OSHA / ADOSH reporting contact	Corporate Safety Officer: Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912
Jobsite posting kit	Per the Company portable posting kit program, entity-specific

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APPENDIX B. VARIANT RECORD

THG CORP

OFFICE SUBSET. CHAPTER TREATMENT SHEET

the corporate office IIPP. The chapters of this manual are used as treated below, plus Module OFC-01. A short manual for a low-hazard workplace is the point; padding it with field content would only bury what matters.

How the Subset Works

THG Corp is the corporate office. Its manual is the same Hays Group system scaled to office reality: the IIPP, the enforcement standard, stop work, incident reporting, records, emergency action, first aid, and workplace violence prevention are fully in force. Field chapters that have no office application stay out, and office-specific content lives in Module OFC-01. This manual is issued by and speaks only for THG Corp. Office employees of THG Corp who visit jobsites of any Hays Group company follow that site's rules and orientation as visitors while there.

Chapter-by-Chapter Treatment

Chapter	Office Subset Treatment
1 through 3	Retained in full. The IIPP (T8 3203) applies to office employers; the Corporate Safety Officer administers it, and office managers implement it. Periodic inspections become the quarterly office inspection on the facility checklist.
4. Code of Safe Practices	Retained, assembled from OFC-01: a one-page office version.
5. Enforcement	Retained in full. One standard company-wide. The 7 Rules apply where the exposure exists (Rule 6 in every vehicle, Rule 7 every day); the ladder and committee govern office conduct the same as field.
6. Stop Work Authority	Retained in full.
7. Pre-Task Planning	Not carried as a daily requirement. Non-routine tasks with real hazards (moves, storage work at height, event setup, facility repairs) get a hazard review under OFC-01 Section 4 before the work.
8. Incident Investigation	Retained in full, same clocks, including the Cal/OSHA 8-hour serious injury report. Office injuries get Form 10A like everything else.
9. Recordkeeping	Retained in full.
10. Hazard Communication	Retained, trimmed scope: janitorial and facility chemicals, toner, and kitchen products. SDS binder location posted; no chemical without an SDS on file.
11. PPE	Retained, task-based: PPE is issued for the rare office tasks that need it per OFC-01, and jobsite-visit PPE is issued before any site visit.

12. Heat Illness	Indoor provisions (T8 3396) apply if any work area reaches 82 degrees, including HVAC failure; facility management responds under OFC-01. Outdoor provisions apply to any employee assigned outdoor tasks.
13. Emergency Action and Fire	Retained in full and central: posted evacuation maps, muster point, accounting for staff and visitors, annual drill, extinguisher program.
14. First Aid	Retained: stocked kits, AED inspected monthly with location posted, trained first aid/CPR personnel on staff per shift coverage.
15. Fit for Duty, D&A, Fatigue	Retained. The Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy applies per its terms.
16. Housekeeping and Surfaces	Retained, office scope per OFC-01: cords, aisles, spills, and storage.
17. Material Handling / Ergonomics	Replaced by OFC-01 Sections 2 and 3: workstation ergonomics and office lifting.
18. Tools / 19. Ladders	Trimmed to OFC-01 Section 4: stepstools and ladders for storage access, inspected, three points of contact, no chairs as ladders.
20. Workplace Violence	Retained in full. LC 6401.9 squarely covers the office: the WVPP, the violent incident log, and annual training are statutory. Front-desk and visitor procedures per the WVPP.
21. Short Service Employees	Trimmed to the orientation gate: every new office employee completes orientation before starting, including emergency plan, reporting, WVPP, and OFC-01.
22. Subcontractor Management	Not carried. Facility vendors and contractors working in the office are coordinated by office management: certificate of insurance, check-in, work area protection, and our emergency plan briefed. Construction work at the office is contracted through an operating entity and follows its program.
23. Training and Orientation	Retained, trimmed matrix: orientation, emergency action, WVPP annual, first aid team, ergonomics awareness, and driver requirements for those who drive on company business.
24. Return to Work	Retained in full.
25. Driving and Fleet Safety	Retained for employees driving on company business, including personal vehicles on company errands: Rule 6, phone down, and the Fleet program's driver requirements where assigned a vehicle.

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PART II. WORK MODULES

THG CORP

MODULE OFC-01. OFFICE SAFETY AND ERGONOMICS

The office work module for THG Corp. Office managers implement it; every office employee follows it.

1. The Office Hazards That Actually Hurt People

Office injuries are real claims and real pain: falls on stairs and slick floors, trips over cords and open drawers, strains from lifting boxes and moving furniture, and repetitive strain at workstations. None of them require bad luck; all of them have controls, and the controls are everyone's job, not the facility manager's alone.

2. Workstations and Ergonomics

- Every workstation is set up to fit the person: chair adjusted so feet rest flat and thighs are level, monitor at eye height about an arm's length away, keyboard and mouse at elbow height with wrists neutral, and frequently used items within easy reach.
- New employees get a workstation setup review at orientation; anyone can request an ergonomic evaluation from HR at any time, and equipment adjustments (chairs, risers, keyboards) are handled as safety purchases, not favors.
- Movement is a control: change posture, stand, and take short eye and stretch breaks through the day. Sustained discomfort, numbness, or tingling is reported early under Chapter 17's early-reporting rule; early reports get fixed, late reports become claims.

3. Lifting and Moving in the Office

- Boxes, paper cases, water bottles, and furniture follow Chapter 17: size it up, use the cart or hand truck (kept accessible, not buried in storage), team lift the awkward stuff, and keep the path clear before you pick anything up.
- Overhead storage holds light items only; heavy items live between knee and shoulder height. Nothing is stored on top of cabinets where it can fall.

4. Housekeeping, Storage, and Non-Routine Tasks

- Aisles, stairs, and exits stay clear, period. Cords and cables are routed and secured out of walkways; a cord across a walkway is fixed the day it appears, not managed around.
- Spills are cleaned or guarded immediately by whoever finds them. Wet floors get signage. File and desk drawers are closed when unattended; cabinets are loaded bottom-heavy so they cannot tip.
- Storage access uses a stepstool or ladder, inspected, three points of contact, never a chair, box, or desk. Ladders follow Chapter 19.

- Non-routine tasks with real hazards (office moves, storage work at height, event setup, hanging or mounting, facility repairs) get a quick documented hazard review with the office manager before the work: what could go wrong, who does it, what equipment, and whether it belongs with a vendor instead.

5. Electrical and Fire

- Power strips plug into wall outlets, never into other power strips, and extension cords are temporary by definition: anything permanent gets an outlet installed. Damaged cords are taken out of service.
- Space heaters, if permitted by office management, are listed models with tip-over shutoff, kept clear of combustibles, and off when unattended. Kitchen appliances stay clean and attended in use.
- Nothing blocks electrical panels, extinguishers, or sprinkler heads; storage stays 18 inches below sprinklers.

6. Visitors and Site Visits

- Visitors sign in, are hosted, and are included in any evacuation accounting. The front desk follows the WVPP procedures for unexpected or escalating visitors.
- Office employees visiting any jobsite are visitors under that site's rules: orientation, PPE issued before the visit (hard hat, glasses, hi-vis, proper footwear), escort per the site, and no wandering the work. The site superintendent's word governs on site.

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